

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What is the basement of the house like?



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How many people you know have a basement in their house or apartment building?
- What does it look like?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about domestic activities.
- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can explain how to do things.





Let's Explore!

If Vanessa's landlord has to spend a lot of money on it, he'll probably **raise the rent***.

* When the landlord *"raises the rent"* it costs more to live in the apartment.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hey Vanessa, have you called the landlord about your basement yet?
- Vanessa:** No, I was going to but I haven't been down there in a while.
- Sally:** Weren't you supposed to look for problems like leakages? Your landlord should maintain it.
- Vanessa:** He was going to have it renovated, but he never got around to doing it.
- Sally:** It could be a mess down there. Wasn't it leaking?
- Vanessa:** I know. He was supposed to send me a contact number for someone to look at it. I'm still waiting for it.
- Sally:** You should follow up on that. Get some information yourself and pass it on. If he has to spend a lot of money on it, he'll probably raise the rent. Besides, it's unhealthy. When was the last time he had any work done?
- Vanessa:** Not since I moved here. He was going to do some repairs that year. He got an estimate, but didn't have the money. I'll remind him. You're right. It's probably moldy! I'm allergic to mold! The basement needs to be sealed properly and thoroughly cleaned. I can't keep anything down there.
- Sally:** He needs to install a dehumidifier. You can call the landlord tenant hotline if he does nothing. They can call and remind him of his obligations.
- Vanessa:** You're right. I'll call him tonight and get him to get someone in here. If he does nothing again, I will call the hotline.



Let's Practice!

The landlord* is supposed to ...

* A "landlord" is someone who owns and rents out property to tenants.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select all the things the landlord is supposed to do for Vanessa. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| 1. ___ send Vanessa a contact | 6. ___ call Sally |
| 2. ___ raise Vanessa's rent | 7. ___ remind the tenant of their obligations |
| 3. ___ eat lunch with Vanessa | 8. ___ rent out the basement |
| 4. ___ keep up his property | 9. ___ estimate the price of the renovation |
| 5. ___ have the basement renovated | 10. ___ install a dehumidifier |



Let's Practice!

Problems in Vanessa's basement.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes you find. Correct the sentences.

- No, I was going to but I haven been doing down there in a while.

- Weren't you supposing to look for problems like leakages?

- He was going to have it renovated, but he never is getting around to doing it.

- He was supposed to send me a contact number for someone to looking at it.

- He were going to do some repairs that year.

- He's supposed to keeping up his property.



Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about problems with your basement.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look up problems with basements and take some notes.
- Use the notes to help you write a dialogue between friends talking about the problems they have in their basements.
- Suggest what they can do to get the basement fixed or renovated.
- Say what they would like it to look like when it's done.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about problems in basements.

☐ ☐

I say how the problems can be solved.

☐ ☐

I say what I want the basement to look like.

☐ ☐

I explain how it can be done.

☐ ☐

Target Words

- allergic** (adjective): having an allergy
e.g. I'm allergic to mold.
- basement** (noun): the lowest living space usually below the ground level
e.g. The basement needs to be sealed properly and thoroughly cleaned.
- leakage** (noun): something that leaks in or out
e.g. Weren't you supposed to look for problems like leakages?
- moldy** (adjective): overgrown or covered with mold
e.g. It's probably moldy! I'm allergic to mold.
- contact** (noun): a person who might be of important use
e.g. He was supposed to send me a contact number for someone to look at it.





Learning Points

Explaining How Things Were Done

You use *be supposed to* and *was going to* to explain how things were done.

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements. You can use this structure using the Past tense to talk about things that you were obligated to do, but didn't or couldn't do.

The structure is:

Subject + to be + *supposed to* + verb

*He **was supposed to have** it renovated, but he never got around to doing it.*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say *be supposed to*, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this: Be suppose_to

You use the structure **was going to** when you want to talk about things that you had planned or intended to do.

The structure is:

was/were + *going to* + verb

*I **was going to call** but I haven't been down there in a while.*

Examples:

- *He was supposed to send me a contact number for someone to look at it. I'm still waiting for it.*
- *He was going to have it renovated, but he never got around to doing it.*
- *He was going to do some repairs that year.*
- *He's supposed to keep up his property.*

